

BRANDON MINER

San Francisco, CA

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Forward Deployed Engineer — End-to-end ML systems on customer infrastructure — from stakeholder needs through production deployment

Education

University of San Francisco

M.S. in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence

San Francisco, CA

Jul 2025 – Jun 2026

San Diego State University

B.S. in Statistics with Emphasis in Data Science, Minor in Mathematics

San Diego, CA

Aug 2022 – Dec 2025

Experience

Forward Deployed Engineer

ACLU

San Francisco, CA

Oct 2025 – Jun 2026

- Owned end-to-end delivery of a production **ML inference platform** (Python, FastAPI, MySQL, Docker) deployed directly on client hardware — from requirements gathering through deployment — eliminating **300+ hours** of manual review per monthly cycle.
- Embedded with non-technical stakeholders to translate operational needs into a **GPU-accelerated ETL and inference pipeline** using **FFmpeg** and **Whisper ASR**, processing **600+ videos per month** with zero cloud dependency.
- Architected and shipped a **multi-stage NLP classification system** combining LLM-assisted auto-labeling, iterative fine-tuning, and structured output parsing — delivering audit-ready signals directly in the hands of end-users.
- Deployed the full ML stack on a **private-server FastAPI backend** with a **React.js** web frontend, enabling non-technical civil rights investigators to run inference without any engineering support.

Data Scientist, Lead Intern

San Diego County Taxpayers Association

San Diego, CA

Mar 2024 – Aug 2025

- Led a cross-functional team of **4 analysts** to build data pipelines and deliver analytical products directly to government stakeholders, translating messy public datasets into actionable policy insights.
- Designed and deployed an end-to-end **data standardization pipeline** combining iterative web scraping and text normalization; applied regression modeling to quantify a **19.7% police wage increase** per **1%** staffing reduction — findings presented to county officials.
- Applied **mixed-effects regression** with VIF-based multicollinearity reduction to regional homelessness expenditure data; surfaced high-impact interventions to guide resource allocation decisions for program leadership.

Technical Projects

GenAI Franchise Personality Quiz

- Built an end-to-end quiz generator: users describe any fictional class system in natural language; Gemini parses the franchise, scrapes Fandom wikis for canon characters, and roleplays each through 15 Likert questions to produce reference vectors asynchronously via FastAPI background jobs.
- Deployed a split architecture on Vercel (frontend) and Google Cloud Run (API), with durable quiz artifacts in GCS, shareable quiz URLs, a community quiz library, and GitHub Actions CI (pre-commit, pytest, automated API deploy).

Parkcast-SF: San Francisco Parking Assistant

- Owned system design and the production **FastAPI** inference API for a full-stack USF capstone parking platform, serving block-level **LightGBM** occupancy predictions from artifacts in **GCS**.
- Applied **K-nearest neighbors**-derived baselines to support **LightGBM** inference on sparse, non-metered blocks where direct sensor history was unavailable.
- Built automated model **CI/CD** on **GCP**: scheduled **GitHub Actions** retraining with **MLflow** experiment tracking and a **champion/challenger** promotion gate (validation MAE) before GCS upload; split deploy across **Vercel** (frontend) and **Cloud Run** (API).

Technical Skills

Programming & Frameworks: Python (FastAPI, PyTorch, Pandas), JavaScript (React.js), SQL (PostgreSQL), Bash

Delivery & Infrastructure: Docker, Docker Compose, Google Cloud Run, private-server deployment, client-hardware deployment, GPU-accelerated inference, REST APIs, GitHub Actions CI/CD

ML Systems: LLM-assisted labeling, NLP pipelines, multi-source ETL, batch inference, stakeholder requirements gathering

Soft Skills: customer embedding, cross-functional leadership, communication with non-technical stakeholders